

NIKHIL KESARKAR

Senior Data Engineer | Azure · Databricks · Microsoft Fabric

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 4+ years architecting and optimizing cloud-scale ETL/ELT pipelines on Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse Analytics, Databricks, and Microsoft Fabric. Delivered a firm-wide Lakehouse platform serving ~20,000 users and cut cloud compute costs 30% through Delta Lake tuning, Z-Ordering, and incremental processing. Microsoft- and Databricks-certified engineer with a proven record of leading proof-of-concepts, large-scale data migrations, and CI/CD automation across enterprise data estates.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Data Platforms: Microsoft Azure, Azure Data Factory (ADF), Azure Synapse Analytics, Azure Databricks, Microsoft Fabric, ADLS Gen2, Azure SQL Database, Delta Lake, OneLake

Data Engineering: ETL/ELT Pipeline Design, Lakehouse & Medallion Architecture, Data Modeling (Star & Snowflake Schema), Data Migration, Data Governance, Unity Catalog, Performance Tuning

Programming: Python, PySpark, Spark SQL, SQL (T-SQL), Object-Oriented Programming

DevOps & Methodology: Azure DevOps, CI/CD, Git, MLflow, Power BI, Scrum/Agile, Jira

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer Consultant — KPMG India

Apr 2025 – Present

- **Cut cloud compute spend 30% and migrated 75% of client workloads to Azure** by architecting Synapse workspace segregation and end-to-end Data Lake migrations.
- **Delivered a firm-wide Lakehouse platform and executive dashboard for ~20,000 employees**, engineering Delta Lake models with optimized partitioning and incremental loads to enable faster, governed enterprise reporting.
- **Engineered 100+ production ETL/ELT pipelines** across Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse, and Databricks, integrating complex on-premises and cloud sources into ADLS Gen2.
- **Reduced query latency and compute cost** by tuning PySpark and Delta Lake workloads with advanced partitioning, Z-Ordering, and data-skipping strategies while sustaining high-speed retrieval for enterprise analytics.
- **Delivered 40+ manufacturing KPIs** for inventory and operations visibility through Azure Synapse pipelines, achieving 100% UAT pass on the first iteration and meeting all delivery timelines.
- **Led a Microsoft Fabric proof-of-concept** evaluating OneLake, Lakehouse, and Direct Lake; the validated cost and performance outcomes drove the team's decision to migrate select production artifacts (pipelines and semantic models) to Fabric.
- **Drove 80% user adoption and a 20% gain in team efficiency** by designing and leading an Azure and Databricks enablement program for 25+ stakeholders.

Data Engineer Consultant — KPMG India

May 2022 – Mar 2025

- **Accelerated Power BI report and query performance** by developing optimized Star Schema and Snowflake Schema data models within Azure Synapse Dedicated SQL Pools.
- **Automated CI/CD across Dev, Test, and Production** using Azure DevOps and Git, cutting manual deployment overhead and ensuring the stability of enterprise-grade data pipelines.
- **Improved data-retrieval performance** by redesigning domain data models for seamless integration with enterprise reporting tools, reducing downstream rework and alignment errors.
- **Built Databricks dashboard proof-of-concepts and implemented MLflow** to establish the foundation for the firm's future machine-learning integration.
- **Recognized as a Top 5 Learner** in the Digital Lighthouse practice for completing 5+ advanced Azure and Databricks certifications.

Consultant Trainee — KPMG India

Jan 2022 – May 2022

- **Earned a Pre-Placement Offer (PPO)** for high performance supporting Data Lake implementation and operations.
- **Built 15+ end-to-end Azure data pipelines and Power BI dashboards** supporting executive decision-making.

EDUCATION

M.Tech, Data Science — NMIMS University, Mumbai

2020 – 2022

CGPA: 3.88 / 4.0

B.E., Computer Engineering — University of Mumbai

2016 – 2020

CGPA: 8.55 / 10

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Data Engineer Associate — Microsoft (Jun 2025)
- Databricks Certified: Data Engineer Professional — Databricks (Jul 2023)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate — Microsoft (Jun 2023)